

Quantum Teleportation: Protocol, Implementation, and Applications

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(Dated: May 24, 2026)

Abstract

This report provides a comprehensive study of quantum teleportation, covering its protocol, implementation, and applications. We begin with an introduction to the fundamental concepts and historical development of quantum teleportation. We then present the theoretical framework and the step-by-step protocol for achieving quantum teleportation. Following this, we discuss various implementation strategies and their practical challenges. Finally, we explore the current and potential applications of quantum teleportation in quantum information processing and communication.

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I. INTRODUCTION

II. MATHEMATICAL BACKGROUND

A. Qubits and the Hilbert Space Formalism

The fundamental unit of quantum information is the "qubit". Unlike classical bit, which takes the value of either 0 or 1 at one of the time, a qubit exists in a two-dimensional Hilbert space $\mathcal{H} = \text{span}\{|0\rangle, |1\rangle\} \cong \mathbb{C}^2$, and its state can be described by a unit vector with an orthonormal computational basis $\{|0\rangle, |1\rangle\}$

$$|\psi\rangle = \alpha|0\rangle + \beta|1\rangle, \quad \alpha, \beta \in \mathbb{C}, \quad |\alpha|^2 + |\beta|^2 = 1 \quad (1)$$

where α and β are the probability amplitudes: measurement yielding $|0\rangle$ or $|1\rangle$ has a probability $|\alpha|^2$ and $|\beta|^2$, respectively [1]. Unlike classical bit, a qubit can exist in a superposition of both states, which has no classical analogue. Physical realization of qubits include the two polarization of photon and two energy levels of an electron in an atom.

Bloch Sphere As an phase factor $e^{i\gamma}$ does not have observable effect, Eq. 1 can be written in a more general expression

$$|\psi\rangle = \cos \frac{\theta}{2} |0\rangle + e^{i\varphi} \sin \frac{\theta}{2} |1\rangle, \quad \theta \in [0, \pi], \quad \varphi \in [0, 2\pi) \quad (2)$$

The two parameters θ and φ define a unique point on the unit three-dimensional sphere, known as the Bloch sphere as shown in Figure 1. The north pole ($\theta = 0$) corresponds to $|0\rangle$, while the south pole corresponds to $|1\rangle$, and every point on the equator represents an equal superposition such as $|+\rangle = (|0\rangle + |1\rangle)/\sqrt{2}$.

Multi-qubit systems. For a system of two qubits, we use the tensor product of the individual Hilbert space $\mathcal{H}_{12} = \mathcal{H}_1 \otimes \mathcal{H}_2 \cong \mathbb{C}^4$ to represent the state space, with computational basis kets $\{|00\rangle, |01\rangle, |10\rangle, |11\rangle\}$. Here we use the ordering convention. That is, $|01\rangle = |0\rangle_1 \otimes |1\rangle_1$. Similarly, if it is a system of three qubits, then $|010\rangle = |0\rangle_1 \otimes |1\rangle_2 \otimes |0\rangle_3$. A general two-qubit state takes the form

$$|\psi\rangle = \alpha_{00} |00\rangle + \alpha_{01} |01\rangle + \alpha_{10} |10\rangle + \alpha_{11} |11\rangle, \quad \sum_x |\alpha_x|^2 = 1 \quad (3)$$

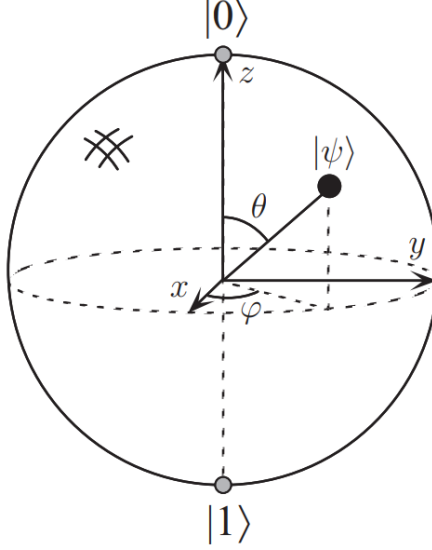


FIG. 1: Bloch sphere schematic. An arbitrary qubit can be represented by one point on the sphere [1].

B. Entanglement and the Bell States

A two-qubit state is called separable if it can be factored as $|\psi\phi\rangle = |\psi\rangle_A \otimes |\phi\rangle_B$. This means that qubit A is in state $|\psi\rangle$, while qubit B is in state $|\phi\rangle$. On the other hand, an entangled state can not be factorized into the product of two single-qubit states. In this case, the quantum state can only be understood as a property of the whole system. The most important entangled states for quantum teleportation are the Bell states [1, 2]

$$\begin{aligned} |\Phi^+\rangle &= \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}(|00\rangle + |11\rangle), & |\Phi^-\rangle &= \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}(|00\rangle - |11\rangle) \\ |\Psi^+\rangle &= \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}(|01\rangle + |10\rangle), & |\Psi^-\rangle &= \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}(|01\rangle - |10\rangle). \end{aligned} \quad (4)$$

These four states form an orthonormal basis for the two-qubit Hilbert space. Besides, they are maximally entangled: tracing out either qubit leaves the reduced density matrix $\rho = I/2$, where I is the identity matrix. For example, consider the Bell state $|\Phi^+\rangle_{AB}$, then the corresponding density matrix is $\rho_{AB} = |\Phi^+\rangle\langle\Phi^+|$. Now, if we only look at the qubit A subsystem, we trace out qubit B to get the reduced density matrix as

$$\rho_A = \text{tr}_B(\rho_{AB}) = \frac{I_A}{2}. \quad (5)$$

Similarly, we have $\rho_B = \frac{I_B}{2}$. This implies that when measuring either qubit, we get equal probability of getting $|0\rangle$ or $|1\rangle$. However, the measurement results of system A and system B are perfectly correlated. For example, if system A measure the entangled state and gets $|0\rangle$, then B gets $|0\rangle$. Similarly, if A obtains $|1\rangle$, then B gets $|1\rangle$. That is, each local measurement result is random, but it becomes highly correlated once we look at the system as a whole.

C. Quantum Measurement and Bell Measurement

The projection postulate state that measurement irreversibly collapses the superposition state into one of its components [3]. Therefore, measurement on the qubit is a physical process that will disturb the original state. A projective measurement is described by a Hermitian observable $M = \sum_m m P_m$, where $\{P_m\}$ are orthogonal projection operator onto the eigenspace of M with eigenvalue m and satisfy $\sum_m P_m = I$ and $P_m P_{m'} = \delta_{mm'} P_m$. Given a pure state $|\psi\rangle$, the probability of obtaining outcome m is

$$p(m) = \langle \psi | P_m | \psi \rangle \quad (6)$$

and the post-measurement state collapses to [1]

$$|\psi_m\rangle = \frac{P_m |\psi\rangle}{\sqrt{p(m)}}. \quad (7)$$

For example, consider a qubit $|\psi\rangle = \alpha |0\rangle + \beta |1\rangle$ with $|\alpha|^2 + |\beta|^2 = 1$. If we do the measurement in the computational basis $\{|0\rangle, |1\rangle\}$, then the corresponding projection operators are $P_0 = |0\rangle\langle 0|$, $P_1 = |1\rangle\langle 1|$. The probability and the post-measurement states of the two possible outcomes are

$$\begin{aligned} p(0) &= \langle \psi | P_0 | \psi \rangle = |\alpha|^2, & P_0 |\psi\rangle &= |0\rangle\langle 0| (\alpha |0\rangle + \beta |1\rangle) = \alpha |0\rangle \\ p(1) &= \langle \psi | P_1 | \psi \rangle = |\beta|^2, & P_1 |\psi\rangle &= |1\rangle\langle 1| (\alpha |0\rangle + \beta |1\rangle) = \beta |1\rangle. \end{aligned} \quad (8)$$

Therefore, a direct measurement gives either 0 or 1, and the original coefficients disappear due to the normalization (Equation 7), and thus the original qubit state is no longer available. In order to maintain the original qubit state, in quantum teleportation, a Bell measurement is performed on a two-qubit system. Similar to the projective measurement, we define the

Bell-measurement projectors as

$$P_k = |\beta_k\rangle \langle \beta_k|, \quad |\beta_k\rangle \in \{|\Psi^\pm\rangle, |\Phi^\pm\rangle\}. \quad (9)$$

Thus, a Bell measurement yields one of the Bell states. That is, computational-basis measurement tells us whether each qubit is individually in $|0\rangle$ or $|1\rangle$, while a Bell measurement implies which Bell state the two-qubit system occupies as a whole.

D. Pauli Operators and Unitary Correction

The Pauli operators are a set of 2×2 unitary matrices forming a basis for the space of single-qubit operators [1]:

$$\begin{aligned} I &= \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}, & X &= \sigma_1 = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}, \\ Z &= \sigma_3 = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & -1 \end{pmatrix}, & Y &= \sigma_2 = iXZ = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & -i \\ i & 0 \end{pmatrix}. \end{aligned} \quad (10)$$

These are the standard single-qubit Pauli operators used in the quantum information. In particular, X is a bit-flip operator ($X|0\rangle = |1\rangle$, $X|1\rangle = |0\rangle$), Z acts as a phase-flip operator ($Z|0\rangle = |0\rangle$, $Z|1\rangle = -|1\rangle$), while Y is the same operator as XZ up to a phase factor. Therefore, we will just use XZ in the later protocol operation. These four operators $\{I, X, Z, XZ\}$ will serve as the unitary correction operators for Bob to recover the original quantum state after Alice's Bell measurement.

III. STANDARD QUANTUM TELEPORTATION PROTOCOL

In this chapter, we use the mathematical tools introduced in the previous chapter to derive the standard quantum teleportation protocol. The goal of the protocol is to transfer an unknown quantum state from Alice to Bob without physically sending the original qubit through a quantum channel. Instead, the protocol uses one shared Bell pair, one Bell measurement, two bits of classical communication, and a conditional Pauli correction.

Suppose Alice has an unknown qubit state

$$|\psi\rangle_1 = \alpha|0\rangle_1 + \beta|1\rangle_1, \quad |\alpha|^2 + |\beta|^2 = 1. \quad (11)$$

Here the subscript 1 labels the unknown input qubit. Alice does not know the coefficients, and she may not measure it directly as the post-measurement state would collapse. Therefore, Alice and Bob share an entangled Bell pair, say

$$|\Phi^+\rangle_{23} = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}(|00\rangle_{23} + |11\rangle_{23}), \quad (12)$$

where qubit 2 and 3 are held by Alice and Bob respectively. The total initial state of the three-qubit system is

$$\begin{aligned} |\Psi\rangle_{123} &= |\psi\rangle_1 |\Phi^+\rangle_{23} \\ &= \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} (\alpha|000\rangle_{123} + \alpha|011\rangle_{123} + \beta|100\rangle_{123} + \beta|111\rangle_{123}), \end{aligned} \quad (13)$$

where in the second line of the equation we expand the total qubit state. Since Alice will perform a Bell measurement on qubit 1 and 2, this suggests us to express the computational basis $|\rangle_{12}$ in terms of the Bell states as

$$\begin{aligned} |00\rangle_{12} &= \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} (|\Phi^+\rangle_{12} + |\Phi^-\rangle_{12}), & |11\rangle_{12} &= \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} (|\Phi^+\rangle_{12} - |\Phi^-\rangle_{12}), \\ |01\rangle_{12} &= \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} (|\Psi^+\rangle_{12} + |\Psi^-\rangle_{12}), & |10\rangle_{12} &= \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} (|\Psi^+\rangle_{12} - |\Psi^-\rangle_{12}). \end{aligned} \quad (14)$$

Thus, the total state becomes

$$|\psi\rangle_1 |\Phi^+\rangle_{23} = \frac{1}{2} \left[|\Phi^+\rangle_{12} (\alpha |0\rangle_3 + \beta |1\rangle_3) + |\Phi^-\rangle_{12} (\alpha |0\rangle_3 - \beta |1\rangle_3) \right. \\ \left. + |\Psi^+\rangle_{12} (\beta |0\rangle_3 + \alpha |1\rangle_3) + |\Psi^-\rangle_{12} (-\beta |0\rangle_3 + \alpha |1\rangle_3) \right]. \quad (15)$$

We may further rewrite this expression using the Pauli operators as

$$|\psi\rangle_1 |\Phi^+\rangle_{23} = \frac{1}{2} \left[|\Phi^+\rangle_{12} |\psi\rangle_3 + |\Phi^-\rangle_{12} Z |\psi\rangle_3 + |\Psi^+\rangle_{12} X |\psi\rangle_3 + |\Psi^-\rangle_{12} XZ |\psi\rangle_3 \right]. \quad (16)$$

This equation is the central identity of quantum teleportation. It shows that when qubits 1 and 2 are written in the Bell basis, Bob's qubit 3 is related to the original input state by one of four possible Pauli operations. Alice now perform a Bell measurement on qubits 1 and 2. According to the projection postulate, the total state collapses into one of the four Bell states with equal probability. If Alice obtains the outcome $|\Phi^+\rangle_{12}$, then Bob's qubit is simply $|\psi\rangle_3$. With no extra correction, the unknown qubit is teleported to Bob. If Alice get $|\Phi^-\rangle_{12}$, then Bob's qubit is $Z |\psi\rangle_3$. Bob need to apply Z so that $Z(Z |\psi\rangle_3) = Z^2 |\psi\rangle_3 = |\psi\rangle_3$. Similarly, if Alice obtains $|\Psi^+\rangle_{12}$, Bob gets $X |\psi\rangle_3$ and need to perform X so that $X(X |\psi\rangle_3) = X^2 |\psi\rangle_3 = |\psi\rangle_3$. Finally, if Alice obtains $|\Psi^-\rangle_{12}$, Bob apply ZX such that $ZX(XZ |\psi\rangle_3) = |\psi\rangle_3$. These four cases can be summarized into the following table as

Alice's Bell outcome	Bob's state before correction	Bob's correction
$ \Phi^+\rangle_{12}$	$ \psi\rangle_3$	I
$ \Phi^-\rangle_{12}$	$Z \psi\rangle_3$	Z
$ \Psi^+\rangle_{12}$	$X \psi\rangle_3$	X
$ \Psi^-\rangle_{12}$	$XZ \psi\rangle_3$	ZX

(17)

After Alice's measurement, she need to tell Bob which one of these four Bell states she got. Since one classical bit has two possible values, 0 and 1, two classical bits can represent four possible messages: 00, 01, 10, and 11. This is enough to label the four Bell-measurement outcomes. For example, they may agree that 00 corresponds to $|\Phi^+\rangle_{12}$. That is, with a two-classical-bit channel, Alice can transport her measurement result to Bob so that he can perform the corresponding correction operation to get the original unknown qubit state. In

source language, the teleportation protocol can be summarized as

$$1 \text{ ebit} + 2 \text{ classical bits} \rightarrow 1 \text{ transmitted qubit.} \quad (18)$$

IV. PHYSICAL MEANING AND EXPERIMENTAL RELEVANCE

After deriving the standard teleportation protocol, it is important to clarify what the protocol does and does not imply physically. Quantum teleportation transfers an unknown quantum state from Alice's qubit to Bob's qubit, but it does not transfer matter, does not create a second copy of the state, and does not allow faster-than-light communication. The protocol works only because of the shared entangled pair and a classical bit channel. In this section, we discuss these physical implications and then connect the ideal protocol to experimental realization.

A. No-Cloning

Quantum teleportation does not create a second copy of the unknown quantum state. Although Bob's final qubit becomes $|\psi\rangle_3 = \alpha|0\rangle_3 + \beta|1\rangle_3$, Alice's original qubit is no longer available after the Bell measurement. The Bell measurement projects qubits 1 and 2 into one of the four Bell states, and therefore irreversibly destroys the original unknown state on Alice's side. This is why quantum teleportation is consistent with the no-cloning theorem. The no-cloning theorem, first formulated by Wootters and Zurek [4] and independently by Dieks [5], states that it is impossible to make an exact copy of an arbitrary unknown quantum state. The proof is straightforward. Suppose there exists a universal unitary cloning machine U such that $U|\psi\rangle|s\rangle = |\psi\rangle|\psi\rangle$ for any unknown state $|\psi\rangle$, where $|s\rangle$ is a blank initial state. If the same machine can also clone another state $|\phi\rangle$, then $U|\phi\rangle|s\rangle = |\phi\rangle|\phi\rangle$. Taking the inner product of these two equations gives $\langle\psi|\phi\rangle = \langle\psi|\phi\rangle^2$. This condition is only satisfied when $\langle\psi|\phi\rangle = 0$ or $\langle\psi|\phi\rangle = 1$. In other words, the two states must be either orthogonal or identical. Therefore, no single unitary operation can clone an arbitrary unknown quantum state [1].

Teleportation avoids this contradiction because it does not copy the state. Instead, the quantum information initially contained in qubit 1 is transferred to qubit 3, while the original state at Alice's side is destroyed by measurement. Therefore, teleportation should be understood as state transfer rather than state duplication.

B. No Faster-Than-Light Communication

Quantum teleportation also does not allow faster-than-light communication. Although the shared Bell pair provides nonclassical correlations between Alice and Bob, Bob cannot recover the unknown state before receiving Alice's classical message. That is, Bob needs Alice's message so that he knows what operation he should apply to recover the unknown qubit. This can be made more precise by looking at Bob's reduced density matrix before the classical message arrives. Since the four Bell-measurement outcomes occur with equal probability, Bob's local state is an average over the four possible states:

$$\rho_3 = \frac{1}{4} (|\psi\rangle\langle\psi| + Z|\psi\rangle\langle\psi|Z + X|\psi\rangle\langle\psi|X + XZ|\psi\rangle\langle\psi|ZX). \quad (19)$$

For an arbitrary qubit $|\psi\rangle = \alpha|0\rangle + \beta|1\rangle$, this average becomes

$$\rho_3 = \frac{I}{2}. \quad (20)$$

Thus, before receiving Alice's classical message, Bob's local state is completely mixed and independent of α and β . Any measurement Bob performs locally gives random results and reveals no information about the unknown input state. Bennett et al. [2] emphasized this point in the original teleportation paper: if Bob tries to complete the protocol by guessing Alice's classical message before it arrives, his state is only a maximally mixed state and gives no information about the input state.

C. Security of the Classical Message

V. EXPERIMENTAL IMPLEMENTATION VIA DUAL-PHOTON ENTANGLEMENT

A. The Quantum Leap from Theory to Lab

The 1998 experiment by Boschi et al. marked a paradigm shift in realizing quantum information protocols. While the canonical Bennett et al. (1993) model required three independent photons—posing formidable temporal synchronization hurdles—this design utilized a sophisticated two-photon, dual-degree-of-freedom architecture. By exploiting both the momentum (path or k-vector) and polarization of a single entangled photon pair, researchers accessed a four-dimensional Hilbert space ($2 \text{ paths} \times 2 \text{ polarizations}$) within a bipartite system. This architectural innovation addressed two primary limitations of prior configurations:

- **100% Success Rate in Bell State Measurement:** Unlike linear-optics three-photon schemes (bounded by a 50% success rate), this approach permits projection onto the complete Bell basis, enabling the deterministic identification of all four states simultaneously.
- **Elimination of Three-Photon Coincidence Hurdles:** Deriving the entire process from a single entangled photon pair (EPR source) circumvents the prohibitive difficulty of synchronizing independent sources within sub-nanosecond coincidence windows.

The physical execution initiates at the EPR source, where the non-local quantum channel is established.

B. Implementation of the Dual-Degree-of-Freedom Setup

1. The EPR Source: Converting Light into Entanglement

Entanglement is generated via Type-II spontaneous parametric down-conversion (SPDC). Specifically, a 200 mW, 351.1 nm ultraviolet argon laser pumps a β -barium borate (BBO) crystal, producing polarization-entangled photon pairs at 702.2 nm. To facilitate the dual-degree architecture, this initial polarization entanglement is deterministically converted into

spatial path entanglement via birefringent calcite crystals (C), which split the incident photons into discrete spatial paths (a and b). The resulting EPR state is described by:

$$|\Psi\rangle = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}(|a_1\rangle|a_2\rangle + |b_1\rangle|b_2\rangle)$$

Crucially, photon 1 is routed toward Alice's station, while photon 2 traverses backreflected paths a_2 and b_2 through the BBO crystal toward Bob.

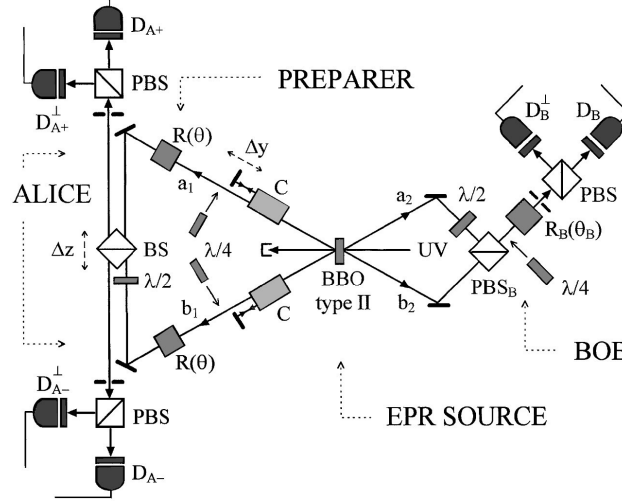


FIG. 2: Diagram of experimental setup showing the separate roles of the preparer, Alice, and Bob.

2. The Preparer: Encoding the Unknown State

A strict logical distinction is maintained between the Preparer and Alice. To ensure the state $|\phi\rangle$ remains fundamentally "unknown," the Preparer encodes it onto photon 1's polarization before it reaches Alice's apparatus. This relies on local unitary operations on paths a_1 and b_1 :

- **Polarization Initialization:** Photon 1 enters with an initial defined polarization (typically vertical, $|v\rangle_1$).
- **Unitary Manipulation:** Quarter-wave plates and Fresnel rhomb rotators (R) transform this into a general pure state: $|\phi\rangle = \alpha|v\rangle_1 + \beta|h\rangle_1$.
- **Path Independence:** Operating identically on paths a_1 and b_1 , the polarization state effectively factors out of the path entanglement.

This yields a global tripartite system where the unknown polarization is carried by the path-entangled photon 1:

$$|\Psi_{total}\rangle = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}(|a_1\rangle|a_2\rangle + |b_1\rangle|b_2\rangle)(\alpha|v\rangle_1 + \beta|h\rangle_1)|h\rangle_2$$

3. *Alice's BSM Engine: Interferometric Bell State Measurement*

Alice's Bell State Measurement (BSM) interferometer projects photon 1's bipartite state onto four orthogonal path-polarization Bell states:

$$|c^\pm\rangle = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}(|a_1\rangle|v\rangle_1 \pm |b_1\rangle|h\rangle_1)$$

$$|d^\pm\rangle = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}(|a_1\rangle|h\rangle_1 \pm |b_1\rangle|v\rangle_1)$$

Prior to entering a 50:50 beam splitter (BS), a Fresnel rhomb in path b_1 induces a 90° polarization rotation. This ensures path and polarization degrees of freedom are properly aligned for interference. The BS then acts as a unitary operator, mapping distinct path-polarization correlations to specific output ports.

The BS is mounted on a micrometrical stage to precisely tune the path-length difference (Δz). Alignment is confirmed by "interference dips" in coincidence count rates, signifying spatiotemporal wave packet overlap.

Mechanics of Detection: Polarizing beam splitters (PBS) sort the emerging photons into four avalanche photodiode detectors ($D_{A+}, D_{A+}^\perp, D_{A-}, D_{A-}^\perp$). Detector coincidences unambiguously project onto the Bell basis:

- A detection at $D_{A+}^\perp$ or $D_{A-}^\perp$ identifies states $|c^\pm\rangle$.
- A detection at D_{A+} or D_{A-} identifies states $|d^\pm\rangle$.

This projective measurement dictates the unitary operation Bob must perform to reconstruct the initial state.

4. Bob's Station: Reconstructing the Teleported State

At the receiving station, photon 2 arrives via trajectories a_2 and b_2 . To resolve the path entanglement, polarization in path a_2 is orthogonally rotated by 90° via a half-wave plate before recombining with path b_2 at the polarizing beam splitter (PBS_B).

Bob employs *passive reconstruction*. Rather than dynamically rotating the state using active electro-optic switches, he reorients his measurement basis to verify the teleported state based on Alice's classical transmission.

Unitary Transformation Logic:

- **Linear States:** Bob adjusts his Fresnel rhomb (R_B) to an angle θ_B , determined by Alice's Bell state outcome.
- **Elliptical States:** Bob inserts a quarter-wave plate at angle γ_B to map the expected elliptical state back into an observable linear basis.
- **Phase Matching:** Bob uses a micrometrical stage to tune Δy , ensuring paths satisfy the phase-matching criteria for high-fidelity verification.

C. The Verdict: Beating the Classical Limit

To rigorously validate quantum teleportation, the experimental fidelity (S)—representing the average probability of the teleported state passing verification—must strictly exceed the classical communication limit of 0.75. Surpassing this threshold empirically proves that entanglement was utilized as a non-local resource. In the 1998 experiment, S was derived through a comprehensive sampling process across three equally spaced linear polarization settings (0° , 120° , and -120°). To ensure a representative result on the Bloch sphere, each of these three states was assigned a weight of $1/3$, while each of the four possible Bell state measurement outcomes was weighted equally at $1/4$. The final observed fidelity of 0.853 ± 0.012 exceeds the classical bound by eight standard deviations. This result robustly confirms that the dual-degree-of-freedom architecture functioned as a unified quantum processor, providing definitive empirical proof of the successful teleportation of unknown pure quantum states.

VI. VARIANTS OF QUANTUM TELEPORTATION

A. Optical Modes System: Continuous-Variable Teleportation

In the previous chapter, we explored the standard quantum teleportation protocol, which is based on discrete-variable (DV) systems and uses photonic qubits as the information carriers. Now, it is reasonable to ask the following question: can we construct a teleportation protocol in an infinite-dimensional Hilbert space instead of only a two-dimensional one?

The answer is yes. Instead of encoding quantum information in a two-level system such as Eq.1. Continuous-variable (CV) teleportation uses quantum states of optical modes. A single optical mode is mathematically equivalent to a quantum harmonic oscillator, whose Hilbert space is spanned by the infinite set of Fock states: $|0\rangle, |1\rangle, |2\rangle, \dots$. Therefore, the state to be teleported is no longer restricted to a qubit. It can be an arbitrary state of one mode of the electromagnetic field, described by continuous quadrature variables. Now I'll give example for CV teleporation using optical modes.

For an optical mode with annihilation operator $\hat{a}$, we define the field quadratures

$$\hat{x} = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}(\hat{a} + \hat{a}^\dagger), \quad \hat{p} = \frac{1}{i\sqrt{2}}(\hat{a} - \hat{a}^\dagger); \quad [\hat{x}, \hat{p}] = i \quad (21)$$

which are analogous to the position and momentum operators of a harmonic oscillator. A quantum state of the optical mode can then be represented in phase space by a Wigner function

$$W_{\text{in}}(\alpha) ; \alpha = x + ip. \quad (22)$$

Thus, we get the continuous-variable version of the EPR state, which is charaterzied by x and p field quadratures. And in reality we cannot create a perfect correlated EPR state between Alices and Bobs because that would require infinite squeezing and therefore infinite energy. Instead, we often adopt convential correlation relations used by Braunstein and Kimble[6]. With x_1 and p_1 being the quadratures of Alice's mode, and x_2 and p_2 being the quadratures of Bob's mode, the EPR correlations can be expressed as

$$x_1 + x_2 \rightarrow 0, \quad p_1 - p_2 \rightarrow 0. \quad (23)$$

With the physics defined clearly we can now see how the continuous-variable teleportation protocol works. Initially, Alice is given an unknown input state as Eq.22, which she wants to teleport to Bob. And Alice and Bob share an EPR state with the correlation in Eq.23.

Starting the teleportation, Alice first combines the unknown input mode with her half of the EPR pair on a 50/50 beam splitter(the lower beam splitter in the green area in Fig.3).

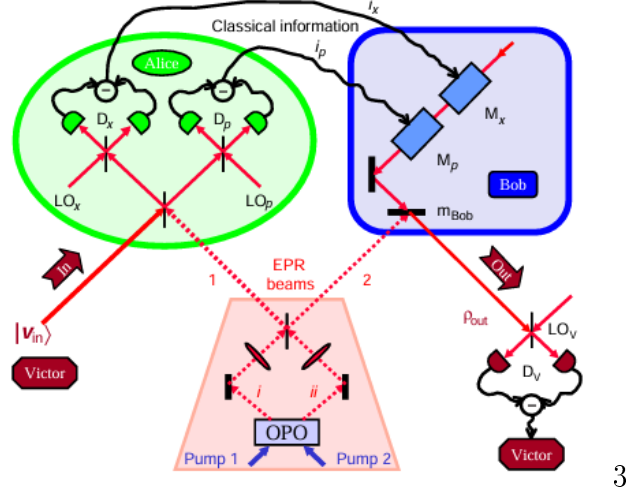


FIG. 3: Diagram of the continuous-variable teleportation experiment by Braunstein and Kimble [6].

The beam splitter produces two output modes,

$$\hat{a}_a = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}(\hat{a}_1 + \hat{a}_{in}), \quad \hat{a}_b = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}(\hat{a}_1 - \hat{a}_{in}). \quad (24)$$

She then performs balanced homodyne measurements on these two modes. Specifically, she measures the quadrature combinations

$$x_a = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}(x_{in} - x_1), \quad p_b = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}(p_{in} + p_1). \quad (25)$$

These measurement outcomes are ordinary classical numbers. Alice sends the values of x_a and p_b to Bob through a classical communication channel(i_x and i_p in Fig.3).

After receiving Alice's measurement results, Bob applies a phase-space displacement to his optical mode. In terms of the complex amplitude, this displacement can be written as

$$\alpha_{out} = \alpha_2 + \sqrt{2}(x_a - ip_b) = g\alpha_{in} + [(x_2 - gx_1) + i(p_2 - gp_1)]. \quad (26)$$

where g describes Bob's (suitably normalized) gain for the transformation from photocurrent to output field.

Using the EPR correlations in Eq. 23, we can see why this reconstructs the input state. For the x and p quadrature,

$$\begin{cases} x_{\text{out}} = x_2 + \sqrt{2}x_a = x_2 + x_1 + x_{\text{in}} \approx x_{\text{in}}, \\ p_{\text{out}} = p_2 - \sqrt{2}p_b = p_2 - p_1 + p_{\text{in}} \approx p_{\text{in}}. \end{cases} \quad (27)$$

Thus, Bob's output mode becomes a copy of Alice's unknown input state, up to the error caused by finite squeezing and imperfect detection. In terms of the Wigner function, the output state is a convolution of the input state with a Gaussian noise:

$$W_{\text{out}}(\alpha) = W_{\text{in}}(\alpha) * G_s(\alpha). \quad (28)$$

Here, G_s is a Gaussian distribution whose variance is determined by the amount of squeezing. For ideal detection,

$$s = e^{-2r}, \quad (29)$$

where r is the squeezing parameter. Therefore, in the limit of infinite squeezing,

$$r \rightarrow \infty, \quad e^{-2r} \rightarrow 0, \quad (30)$$

the Gaussian noise vanishes and the output state becomes exactly equal to the input state:

$$W_{\text{out}}(\alpha) \rightarrow W_{\text{in}}(\alpha). \quad (31)$$

For realistic detectors, however, the output contains additional noise due to imperfect detection efficiency. If the detector amplitude efficiency is η , the effective noise becomes

$$\bar{s} = e^{-2r} + \frac{1 - \eta^2}{\eta^2}. \quad (32)$$

This equation shows the two main limitations of practical CV teleportation, which are finite squeezing and detector loss. Increasing the squeezing reduces the first term, while improving the homodyne detection efficiency reduces the second term.

Up until now, we have described the typical teleportation for continuous variables. Yet, we didn't seem to mention how significant this protocol is or how significant "quantum teleportation" is in general. A useful way to understand the importance is to compare quantum teleportation with a purely classical strategy. If there is no entanglement between the shared state, corresponding to $r = 0$, Alice can only measure the input state and tell Bob what state to prepare. However, because $\hat{x}$ and $\hat{p}$ do not commute, Alice cannot measure both quadratures perfectly at the same time. The measurement necessarily adds quantum noise. Bob's reconstruction also adds noise. Therefore, the classical measure-and-prepare protocol cannot perfectly reproduce the input quantum state. In contrast, when $r > 0$, Alice and Bob share genuine EPR entanglement, and the teleportation fidelity ($F = \langle \psi_{\text{in}} | \rho_{\text{out}} | \psi_{\text{in}} \rangle$) can exceed what's possible with classical methods (see Fig.4).

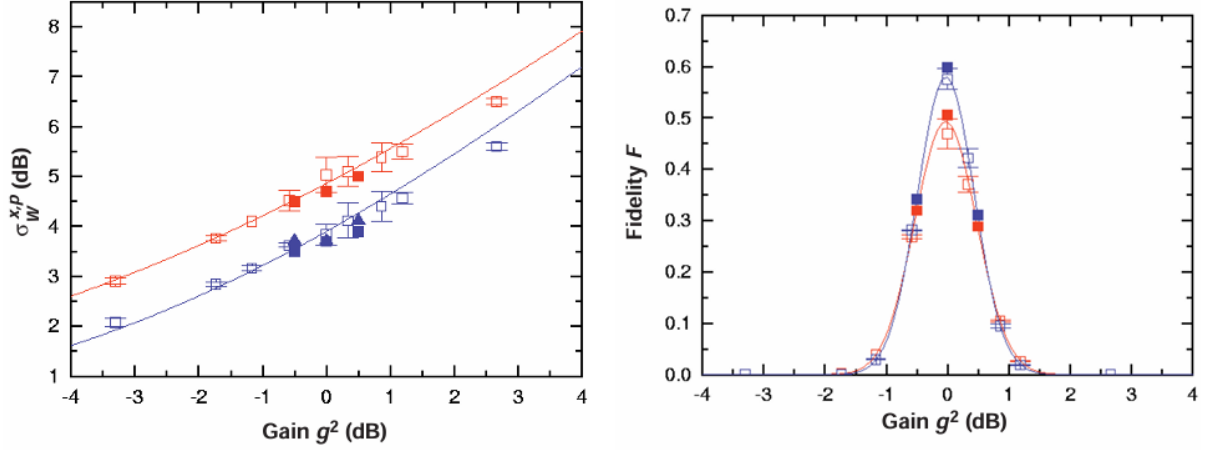


FIG. 4: Experimental result by Braunstein and Kimble[6]. The left figure is the variance of the Bob's state versus g^2 , and the right figure shows the fidelity versus g^2 . The orange line indicates the classical teleportation and blue indicates the quantum teleportation.

In a nutshell, continuous-variable teleportation extends the original teleportation idea from finite-dimensional qubits to infinite-dimensional optical modes. The unknown state is encoded in the quadrature amplitudes of an electromagnetic field mode, which is easily to measure and recreate experimentally. The quality of teleportation is limited by finite squeezing and detector inefficiency, but with sufficient squeezing the protocol can teleport genuinely nonclassical optical states with fidelity beyond any classical measure-and-prepare scheme.

B. Atomic Ensemble Systems

Unlike using photons as the source of quantum information like we discussed above, we can also use atoms as the information carriers. Atomic ensembles in nature are better suited for local storage and synchronization, while photons are better suited for long-distance transmission. Before talking about teleportation using atomic ensembles, I think we quickly go over how we can prepare EPR via atoms first introduced by Hagley *et al.* [7]. In the experiment, two rubidium atoms passed one after another through a high- Q microwave cavity. The first atom was initially prepared in an excited circular Rydberg state $|e\rangle$ (D_e in Fig. 5), the second in a lower state $|g\rangle$ (D_g in Fig. 5), and the cavity was initially in the vacuum state $|0\rangle$.

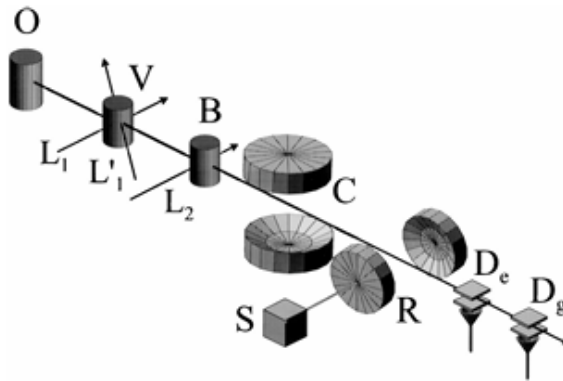


FIG. 5: Diagram of the experiment by Hagley *et al.* [7].

The initial state was therefore,

$$|\Psi_{\text{in}}\rangle = |e_1, g_2, 0\rangle. \quad (33)$$

The first atom interacted with the cavity for a time corresponding to a $\pi/2$ Rabi pulse. This produced a superposition in which the first atom either remained excited and left the cavity empty, or emitted one photon into the cavity:

$$|\Psi'\rangle = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} (|e_1, g_2, 0\rangle - |g_1, g_2, 1\rangle). \quad (34)$$

The second atom then interacted with the cavity for a π pulse. If the photon was present, the second atom absorbed it and was promoted from $|g\rangle$ to $|e\rangle$. After this process, the cavity

returned to the vacuum state, while the two atoms were left in the entangled EPR state

$$|\Psi_{\text{EPR}}\rangle = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} (|e_1, g_2\rangle - |g_1, e_2\rangle). \quad (35)$$

Thus, the cavity field acted as an intermediate quantum bus, which started and ended in the vacuum state, but during the process it mediated the entanglement between the two atoms. The atoms were separated by a distance on the order of a centimeter, showing that EPR-type entanglement could be produced between spatially separated massive particles. The connection to atomic ensemble teleportation becomes clearer when one replaces individual atoms by collective atomic excitations. In an ensemble, the quantum information is not stored in one specific atom, but in a coherent collective mode shared among many atoms. This collective enhancement increases the effective coupling between light and matter and allows the ensemble to behave like a single effective quantum memory. Depending on the encoding, atomic ensembles can be used either in a continuous-variable framework or in a discrete-variable spin-wave framework. In this subsection we will only discuss the continuous-variable approach, because it is relevant to the previous subsection.

In the continuous-variable approach, the collective spin of an ensemble is treated as an effective harmonic oscillator. A representative experiment was performed by Sherson *et al.*, in which a quantum state of light was teleported onto a macroscopic atomic ensemble containing approximately 10^{12} cesium atoms [8]. The atoms were optically pumped into a coherent spin state with a large mean spin along the x -direction (see Fig. 6). The two transverse spin components could then be normalized as canonical variables,

$$\hat{X}_A = \frac{\hat{J}_y^{\text{rot}}}{\sqrt{J_x}}, \quad \hat{P}_A = \frac{\hat{J}_z^{\text{rot}}}{\sqrt{J_x}}, \quad (36)$$

where J_x is the large mean collective spin. Under the condition that the transverse spin fluctuations are small compared with J_x , these variables approximately satisfy

$$[\hat{X}_A, \hat{P}_A] = i. \quad (37)$$

This makes the atomic ensemble mathematically analogous to an optical mode with quadrature operators.

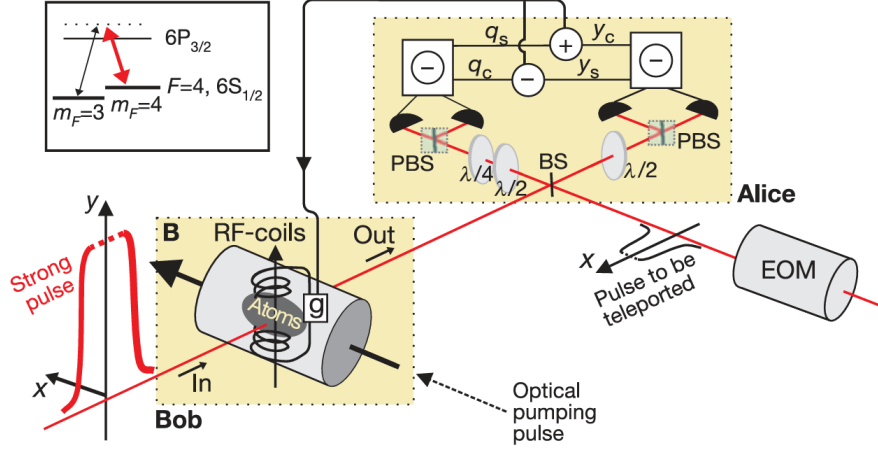


FIG. 6: Diagram of the experiment by Sherson *et al.* [8].

The entanglement resource in the Sherson experiment was created by sending a strong off-resonant light pulse through the atomic ensemble. Through a Faraday-type interaction, the polarization quadratures of the outgoing light became entangled with the collective spin quadratures of the atoms. Physically, the atomic spin rotated the polarization of the light, while the light also acted back on the atoms through the ac Stark effect. After this interaction, the outgoing light pulse was sent to Alice and mixed on a 50/50 beamsplitter with the unknown optical state to be teleported. Alice then performed a Bell measurement using polarization homodyne detection. The resulting classical photocurrents were sent to Bob, who applied radio-frequency magnetic-field pulses to the atomic ensemble. These pulses displaced the collective spin variables according to Alice's measurement result.

Ideally, the feed-forward operation maps the input optical quadratures onto the atomic ensemble,

$$\hat{Y}, \hat{Q} \longrightarrow \hat{X}_A^{\text{tele}}, \hat{P}_A^{\text{tele}}, \quad (38)$$

where $\hat{Y}$ and $\hat{Q}$ are the quadratures of the input light field, and $\hat{X}_A^{\text{tele}}, \hat{P}_A^{\text{tele}}$ are the final teleported atomic variables. The original optical state is not transferred by a direct classical copying process. Instead, the pre-existing light-matter entanglement, the Bell measurement, the classical communication, and the conditional spin displacement together reproduce the input quantum state in the atomic ensemble.

The performance of the teleportation is quantified by the fidelity between the input optical state and the reconstructed atomic state. Sherson *et al.*[8] reported deterministic

teleportation of coherent states with fidelities $F = 0.60 \pm 0.02$ for $\bar{n} = 5$, and $F = 0.58 \pm 0.02$ for $\bar{n} = 20$.

These values exceeded the corresponding classical benchmarks, showing that the process could not be explained as a purely classical measure-and-prepare transfer.

Overall, atomic ensemble systems show how quantum teleportation can become a practical interface between communication and storage. The earlier Rydberg-atom EPR experiment demonstrated that entanglement between massive particles can be engineered through controlled atom-field interaction. Later ensemble experiments extended this idea to macroscopic matter systems, where collective spin states can store, receive, and transmit quantum information.

C. Solid-State System

Optical-mode and atomic-ensemble systems fascinating as quantum teleporatation platforms, however, they might be difficult to integrate into a large-scale quantum network or quantum computer. Now we're going to discuss solid-state systems, where the quantum information is stored and processed in artificial quantum devices fabricated on a chip particuly superconducting circuits. Instead of using freely propagating photons or naturally occurring atoms, this approach uses engineered macroscopic quantum systems whose quantum states behave like controllable two-level systems.

A representative experiment was demonstrated by Steffen *et al.*[9], who realized deterministic quantum teleportation with feed-forward in a superconducting circuit. The system consists of three superconducting transmon qubits, denoted as Q_1 , Q_2 , and Q_3 , coupled to three superconducting coplanar waveguide resonators(see Fig.7).

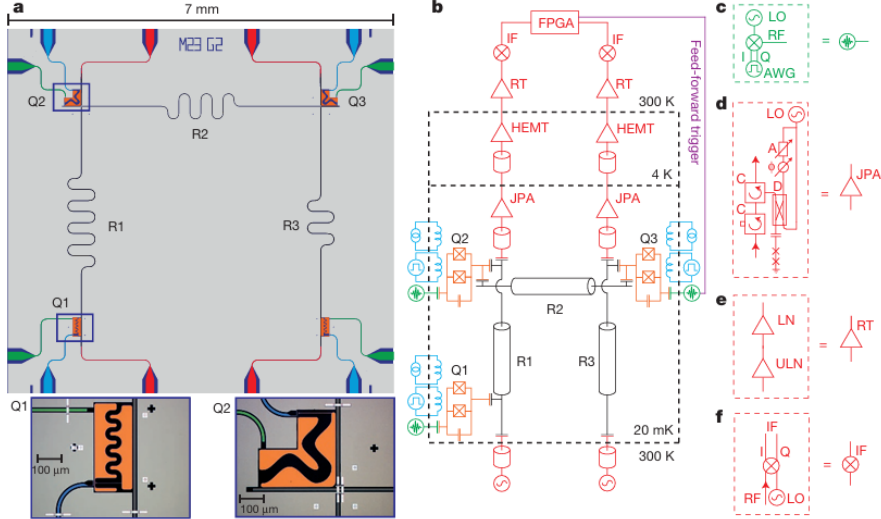


FIG. 7: Diagram of the experiment by Steffen *et al.* [9], figure a is the connection diagram and the figure b-f is detail layout of the ICs.

Initially, Q_1 is the qubit carrying the unknown input state

$$|\psi_{\text{in}}\rangle = \alpha|0\rangle + \beta|1\rangle, \quad (39)$$

while Q_2 and Q_3 are first prepared as an entangled Bell pair. Here Q_1 and Q_2 belong to the sender side, and Q_3 acts as the receiver qubit. Although the qubits are located on the same superconducting chip, the state is not transferred by directly moving the physical carrier from Q_1 to Q_3 . Instead, as in the standard teleportation protocol, the transfer relies on a shared entangled resource and classical information obtained from a Bell-state measurement.

The protocol begins by preparing an entangled state between Q_2 and Q_3 , for example

$$|\Phi^+\rangle_{23} = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} (|00\rangle_{23} + |11\rangle_{23}). \quad (40)$$

This entangled pair plays the same role as the EPR pair in the original teleportation proposal. After this shared resource is created, the unknown state $|\psi_{\text{in}}\rangle$ is prepared on Q_1 . The sender then performs a Bell-state measurement on Q_1 and Q_2 . In the ideal circuit model, this Bell measurement can be understood as a transformation from the Bell basis to the computational basis, followed by ordinary qubit readout. Experimentally, Steffen *et al.* implemented the required two-qubit operations using controlled-PHASE(CPHASE) gates and single-qubit microwave rotations. The CPHASE gates are generated by tuning the transition frequencies

of the transmon qubits with fast flux pulses, while the single-qubit rotations are driven by microwave pulses.

After the Bell-state measurement, the receiver qubit Q_3 is projected into a state related to the original input state by a Pauli operation:

$$|\psi_{\text{out}}\rangle = \{I, X, Z, \tilde{Y}\}|\psi_{\text{in}}\rangle, \quad (41)$$

where the required correction depends on the two classical bits obtained from the Bell measurement. Therefore, the output state is not always immediately equal to $|\psi_{\text{in}}\rangle$; it is equal up to a known single-qubit rotation. To complete the teleportation deterministically, the experiment must identify which Bell-state outcome occurred and then apply the corresponding correction to Q_3 . This final conditional correction is called feed-forward. The feed-forward step applies this correction in real time. The measurement result from Q_1 and Q_2 is sent to control electronics, which then applies the corresponding microwave pulse to Q_3 . In other words, feed-forward is the step that uses the sender's measurement result to complete the teleportation on the receiver qubit.

A key achievement of this solid-state implementation is that it does not merely post-select one successful outcome. In many optical teleportation experiments, only part of the Bell basis can be distinguished, so the protocol succeeds only probabilistically. In this superconducting circuit experiment, Josephson parametric amplifiers were used to perform high-fidelity single-shot measurements. Moreover, the experiment implemented deterministic teleportation with active feed-forward, using all four possible Bell-measurement outcomes.

The reported results show that the teleported state fidelities are above the classical limit. For post-selected teleportation, the average output-state fidelity was about 81.7%, with an average process fidelity of about 72.0%. When all four Bell-state outcomes were distinguished deterministically, the average output-state fidelity was about 77.1%, with a process fidelity of about 65.5%. When real-time feed-forward was included, the directly measured deterministic state-transfer fidelity was about 68.8%, still above the classical threshold of $2/3$ for state teleportation. The lower fidelity in the full feed-forward case mainly came from imperfect qubit coherence, gate errors, readout errors, and the finite delay required for real-time measurement processing and conditional control.

Overall, the solid-state implementation of quantum teleportation provides alternative

rather than photons or atoms with superconducting artificial atoms embedded in a integrated microwave circuit. And with the integrated circuit platform, we can achieve deterministic teleportation with fast feed-forward(around 500ns), which optical or atomic systems are hard to compare. Still, for the three methods the overall protocol involves the same aspects, an unknown input state, a shared entangled pair, classical information communication, and a conditional correction.

VII. ADVANCES IN QUANTUM TELEPORTATION

A. Quantum Teleportation for Quantum Communication

In the previous sections, we detailed discussed different physical platforms for quantum teleportation. Based on the uses of those different platforms and method, the most advanced research focus on using quantum teleportation for quantum communication for potentially quantum internet or quantum computers.

A clear experimental example is the ground-to-satellite quantum teleportation experiment performed using the Micius satellite(Fig. 8)[10]. In this experiment, the quantum state to be teleported was encoded in the polarization of a single photon,

$$|\chi\rangle_1 = \alpha |H\rangle_1 + \beta |V\rangle_1, \quad |\alpha|^2 + |\beta|^2 = 1, \quad (42)$$

where $|H\rangle$ and $|V\rangle$ represent horizontal and vertical polarization. These two polarization states play the role of the qubit basis states $|0\rangle$ and $|1\rangle$. The ground station also prepared an entangled photon pair in the Bell state:

$$|\phi^+\rangle_{23} = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} (|H\rangle_2 |H\rangle_3 + |V\rangle_2 |V\rangle_3). \quad (43)$$

Photon 2 remained at the ground station, while photon 3 was sent through a free-space optical uplink to the satellite. The ground station then performed a Bell-state measurement on photons 1 and 2. Depending on the Bell-state measurement result, the state of photon 3 became either the desired state $|\chi\rangle$, or a state related to it by a known unitary correction such as a π -phase shift. Therefore, the unknown quantum state was not physically carried by photon 1 to the satellite; instead, it was reconstructed in the distant photon 3 by using

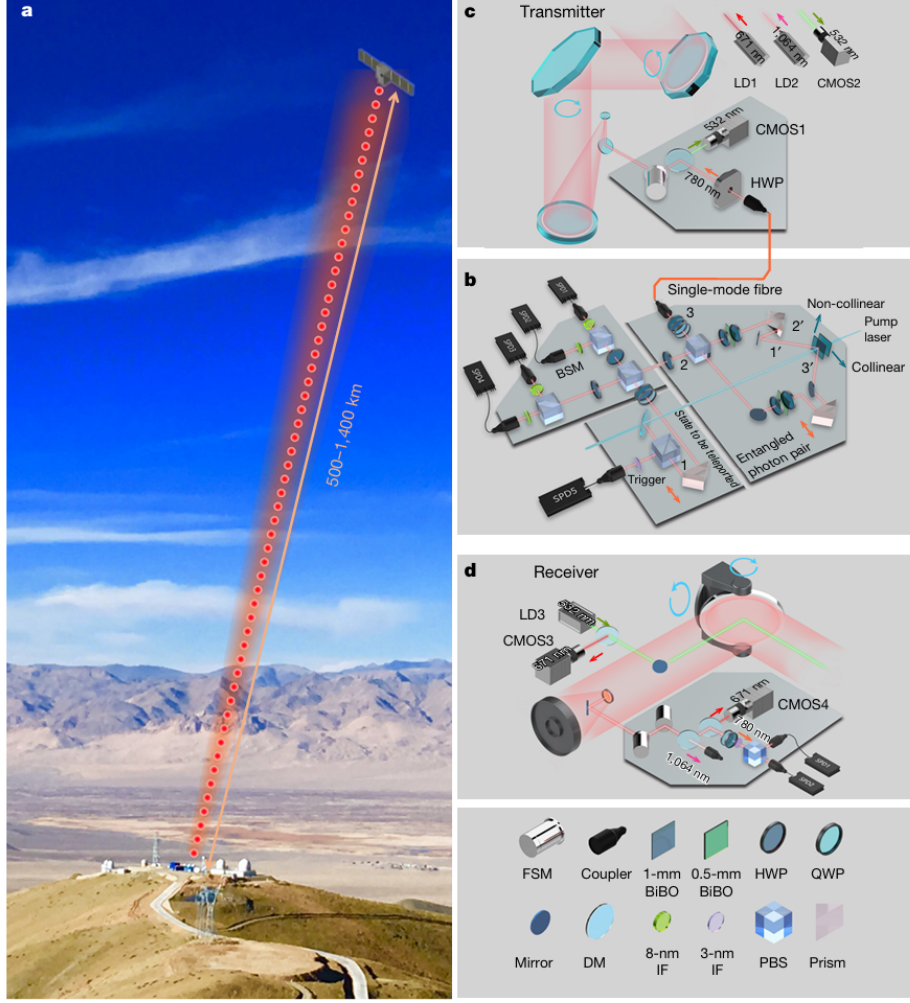


FIG. 8: Diagram of the ground-to-satellite quantum teleportation experiment by Ren *et al.* [10].

entanglement plus classical information.

Previous teleportation experiments using optical fibers or terrestrial free-space channels were limited to roughly the hundred-kilometer scale because loss increases strongly with distance. A satellite link reduces this problem because most of the propagation path is through empty space rather than through an absorbing medium. In the Micius experiment, the teleportation distance varied from about 500 km to 1400 km, with a measured channel loss ranging from about 41 dB to 52 dB. Even with this large loss, the experiment successfully teleported six input states chosen from mutually unbiased bases on the Bloch sphere:

$$|H\rangle, \quad |V\rangle, \quad |+\rangle, \quad |-\rangle, \quad |R\rangle, \quad |L\rangle.$$

The measured average teleportation fidelity was

$$F = 0.80 \pm 0.01,$$

which is clearly above the classical limit of $2/3$.

From an experimental point of view, the propagation direction, or wave vector $\mathbf{k}$, is also crucial. The qubit itself is encoded in polarization, which is defined transverse to the photon's propagation direction. However, in a ground-to-satellite link, the direction of propagation is constantly changing because the satellite moves rapidly relative to the ground station. Atmospheric turbulence also causes beam wandering and beam broadening. Therefore, the experiment required a narrow-divergence transmitting telescope and a precise acquiring, pointing, and tracking system. In addition, polarization compensation using wave plates was needed so that the polarization qubit remained well-defined during transmission.

This result shows that quantum teleportation is not only a conceptual consequence of entanglement, but also a practical building block for a future quantum internet. In such a network, teleportation could be combined with entanglement distribution, quantum memories, and entanglement swapping to connect distant quantum nodes.

B. Quantum Gate Teleportation for Quantum Computing

While standard quantum teleportation transfers an unknown quantum state from one system to another, quantum gate teleportation (QGT) extends the same principle to quantum operations. Instead of physically moving a qubit from one processor to another, QGT uses a previously shared entangled state, local operations, measurement, and classical feed-forward to implement a non-local gate between distant qubits. This idea is especially important for quantum computing, because large-scale quantum processors require many qubits with high connectivity. Building a single device in which every qubit can directly interact with every other qubit is technically difficult. QGT provides an opportunity to effectively create a large processor by connecting smaller modules together.

A recent experimental demonstration by Main *et al.*[11] shows how this idea can be used for distributed quantum computing across an optical network link. In their architecture(see Fig. 9(b)), two trapped-ion modules, labeled Alice and Bob, are separated by about two

meters. Each module contains two functional types of qubits: a *network qubit*, used to create remote entanglement through photons, and a *circuit qubit*, used to store and process the computational quantum information. This separation of roles is essential. The network qubits interact with the optical link and generate entanglement, while the circuit qubits preserve the quantum information during the probabilistic entanglement-generation process.

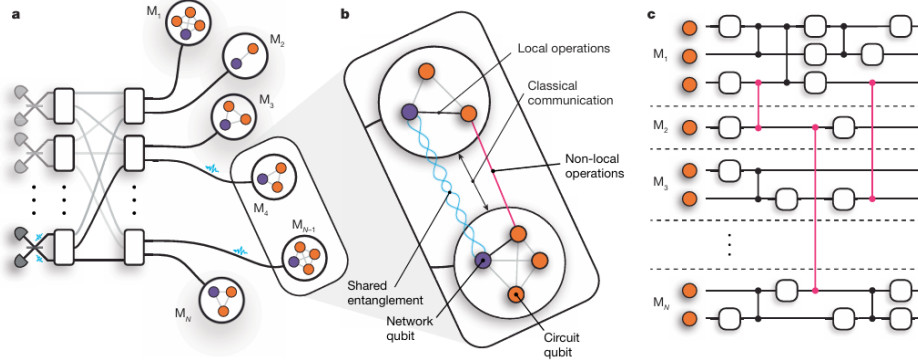


FIG. 9: (a) conceptual diagram of the QGT with multiple modules, (b) QGT setup, (c) physical connection between multiple modules. By Main *et al.* [11].

The central resource is a remotely shared Bell state between the two network qubits,

$$|\Psi^+\rangle_N = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} (|10\rangle + |01\rangle),$$

which is generated by photon-mediated entanglement and heralded by detector clicks. Once this entanglement has been successfully produced, local controlled-Z operations are performed inside each module between the network qubit and the local circuit qubit (see Fig. 10). The network qubits are then measured in chosen bases, and the two modules exchange the measurement outcomes through a classical communication channel. Finally, conditional single-qubit corrections are applied to the circuit qubits. The net effect is that the circuit qubits, which are physically located in different modules, undergo a non-local controlled-Z gate,

$$|\psi_{\text{in}}\rangle_{AB} \longrightarrow U_{\text{CZ}} |\psi_{\text{in}}\rangle_{AB}.$$

Thus, the gate is not produced by a direct physical interaction between the two circuit qubits, but by consuming the previously shared entanglement.

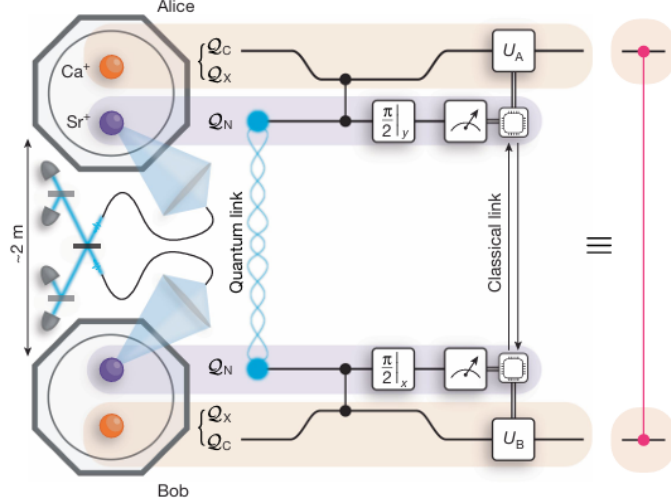


FIG. 10: Teleportation of a CZ gate between two trapped-ion modules. By Main *et al.* [11].

The important point is that the gate teleportation protocol is deterministic after entanglement has been heralded. Photon loss only affects whether the Bell pair is successfully created; it does not destroy the unknown computational state stored in the circuit qubits. This is a major advantage over direct photon-mediated transfer of quantum information, where loss of the photon can correspond to loss of the quantum state itself. In QGT, the quantum channel is only responsible for preparing entanglement, so failed attempts can simply be repeated until success. This makes the method more suitable for scalable architectures.

For the result, they obtained an average gate fidelity of 86.2(9)% on QGT of a controlled-Z gate between two trapped-ion modules. Moreover, the authors also showed that the same QGT process can be repeated several times to build more complicated two-qubit gates. For example, they implemented distributed iSWAP and SWAP gates. The iSWAP gate used two teleported CZ gates and reached a fidelity of 70(2)%, while the SWAP gate used three teleported CZ gates and reached a fidelity of 64(2)%.

Beyond individual gates, the experiment also ran a small distributed quantum algorithm: a two-qubit version of Grover's search algorithm. In this algorithm, one teleported CZ gate was used for the oracle, and another was used for the diffusion operation. For the four possible marked states,

$$a \in \{00, 01, 10, 11\},$$

the system found the correct answer with an average success probability of 71(1)%.

VIII. CONCLUSION

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